

with convenience, simple configuration, and—most elusive of all—security by default. Today's solutions force a choice between security and ease-of-use. Small businesses demand a security solution for wireless networked offices and/or employees that includes:

- o Ease-of-use (including initial installation, configuration and deployment across both large and small networks)
- o Reliable connectivity—associating with an AP
- o Flexibility on a small business budget; and
- o Knowledge of who is on the network and confidentiality of network communications to protect valuable data

In order to reap the benefits of a WLAN implementation, businesses of any size or type are faced with investing in a security solution that protects their network and ensures that critical business functions stay up and running. However, network security has typically relied on how much money a company is willing to invest, what degree of difficulty IT management is ready to accept, and how secure it wishes its network to be. This presents a problem for the small business that is not willing to treat security as an option but has limited IT support and budget to meet their security requirements. Security should be an integrated part of the wireless network and users should be confident that set-up and configuration are no more difficult or time-consuming than standard Microsoft XP “anti” applications. Once the security solution is installed, the small business must be able to safely assume that the WLAN is secure and private.

Should Small Businesses Be Concerned About WLAN Security?

Through 2005, 40 percent of SMBs that manage their own network security and use the Internet for more than e-mail will experience a successful Internet attack, and more than half of them won't know they were attacked.

- Gartner Research